CONFERENCE ABSTRACT

The Role of Panchakarma in Vandhyatwa (Female Infertility): A Comprehensive Review

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> *Female infertility is rarely a one-herb problem. This review maps where classical Panchakarma fits into the modern fertility pathway.*

Abstract

Vandhyatwa (female infertility) is one of the most common yet least discussed clinical presentations in Prasuti Tantra. This comprehensive review evaluates the role of Panchakarma in the management of female infertility, examining both Shodhana (purificatory) and Shamana (palliative) approaches as described in classical texts. The review covers the indications for Virechana, Vamana, Basti and Nasya in the context of reproductive disorders, together with the role of Ahara (diet), Vihara (lifestyle) and Dinacharya as the foundational substrate of any fertility protocol. The paper argues that Panchakarma works best not as an isolated procedure but as the preparatory and corrective stage that makes subsequent conception-oriented care effective, and it discusses the contemporary literature supporting these classical indications.

Panchakarma · Vandhyatwa · Female infertility · Shodhana · Shamana · Ayurveda · Reproductive health · Review

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Abstract

Title: The Role of Panchakarma in Vandhyatwa (Female Infertility): A Comprehensive Review

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Introduction:

Vandhyatwa, commonly known as female infertility, is a multifaceted condition affecting numerous women worldwide. Traditional Ayurvedic medicine offers Panchakarma as a therapeutic intervention for treating various health issues, including infertility. Panchakarma, comprising five cleansing procedures, for the elimination of disease causing factors and to maintain the equilibrium of doshas to promote overall well-being. This review explores the efficacy and mechanisms of Panchakarma in managing Vandhyatwa.

Method:

A systematic literature search was collected from Samhita, Ayurvedic journals, various databases, including PubMed. Studies investigating the role of Panchakarma in treating female infertility were included in the review. Relevant data on methodology, interventions, outcomes, and conclusions were extracted and synthesized.

Results:

Several studies have reported the beneficial effects of Panchakarma in managing female infertility. Panchakarma therapies such as Vamana (therapeutic emesis), Virechana (purgation), Basti (medicated enema) Niruha and Anuvasana and Nasya (nasal administration) have been employed either individually or in combination to address underlying imbalances associated with infertility. These therapies are believed to eliminate toxins, improve reproductive health, regulate menstrual cycles, enhance ovarian function, and optimize hormonal balance, thereby increasing the fertility rate.

Discussion:

Ayurveda oldest system of health gives various panchakarma as shodhan chikitsa and sthanika chikitsa for such gynecological problems. The Vamanadi shodhana karma makes the women free from the diseases. Abhyantara chikitsa breaks dosha-dushya sammurchana and cure diseases. But if the sthanika dosha dushti is more, then sthanika chikitsa is more beneficial. Integrating Ayurvedic principles and Panchakarma therapies into conventional fertility treatments may enhance outcomes and provide a more comprehensive approach to managing female infertility.

Keywords:

'Panchakarma', 'Vandhyatwa', 'Infertility', 'Basti', 'Health'